

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

TermJobs

Contract-only hiring: requisition to candidate submission

Version 2.0 · supersedes v1.0

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Field	Value
Version	v2.0 — supersedes v1.0
Date	09 August 2026
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Scope	The end-to-end flow from a demand owner raising a contract requirement to a vendor submitting candidates and a hiring manager processing them
What changed from v1.0	Client-side roles split into four distinct personas with non-overlapping jobs. Requisition data model rebuilt for contract engagements specifically. Vendor workspace specified as a first-class product surface, not a portal.

1. The worked example

Everything in this document is written against one scenario. If a requirement doesn't serve this scenario, it doesn't belong in v2.0.

PepsiCo India needs a DevOps Engineer for a 6-month contract engagement on a supply-chain platform migration. Rajesh Menon, Engineering Director, owns the budget and the need. Kavita Iyer, HR Manager, owns PepsiCo's panel of 12 empanelled staffing vendors. Arun Deshpande, Engineering Manager, will run the interviews and work with whoever joins.

Rajesh raises the requisition with the JD, the duration, the rate ceiling, and the contract terms. On approval it is released to the empanelled vendors who are scoped to Technology roles. Vendor recruiters at TalentBridge, HireQuest, and Zenith see the requirement in their TermJobs workspace, source candidates, and upload profiles against it. Arun sees those profiles arrive in his pipeline and starts screening.

Critical constraint: TermJobs handles contract engagements only. No permanent hiring. This is a scoping decision, not a limitation — it lets the entire data model assume a fixed-term engagement with a bill rate, a duration, and an end date, which permanent-hiring products cannot assume. Every requisition has a start date and an end date. Every candidate has a bill rate. There is no CTC field anywhere in the product.

2. The four client-side personas and why they are separate

The most common failure in VMS design is collapsing these roles into one "HR user." They have genuinely different jobs, different frequencies of use, and different reasons to distrust the system.

Persona	Example	Their job	Frequency	Never does
Requisition Owner	Rajesh Menon, Engineering Director	Defines the need, owns the budget, sets the commercial ceiling, approves the offer	2-5 times a quarter	Manage vendors. Screen resumes.
HR Manager	Kavita Iyer	Owens the vendor panel end to end: empanel, tier, rate cards, compliance, suspend, terminate. Governs the process.	Daily	Raise requisitions. Decide who to hire.
Hiring Manager	Arun Deshpande, Engineering Manager	Screens submitted profiles, interviews, selects	Daily while a role is open, then not at all	Create requisitions. Talk to vendors directly.
Vendor Recruiter	Meera, TalentBridge	Receives the requirement, sources, submits profiles, tracks status	All day, every day	See other vendors. See internal budget.

2.1 The handoff chain



2.2 Why HR sits in the middle and not at the start

Kavita is not a bottleneck for the sake of process. She sits between Rajesh and the vendors because she is the only person who knows:

- Which vendors are currently compliant (documents valid, not suspended)
- What rate has been contractually agreed for a DevOps Engineer with 5-8 years in Bangalore
- Which vendors have been performing on Technology roles this quarter
- Whether the panel needs widening for this skill

If Rajesh could publish directly to vendors, he would either spam all 12 or pick the two agencies whose sales reps call him most. Both are worse outcomes.

But her approval must be fast or she becomes the reason people go back to email. The requirement is: HR approval of a within-band requisition should take under 60 seconds, with everything she needs to decide on one screen. Out-of-band requisitions are where she actually spends time.

2.3 Permission matrix

F = full · **S** = scoped to own requisitions/BU · **R** = read only · **A** = approve only · — = none

Capability	Requisition Owner	HR Manager	Hiring Manager	Vendor Admin	Vendor Recruiter
Add / edit / remove empanelled vendor	—	F	—	—	—
Set vendor tier, category scope, rate card	—	F	—	R (own)	R (own)
Verify vendor compliance documents	—	F	—	Upload only	—
Suspend / terminate a vendor	—	F	—	—	—
Create requisition	F	F	S	—	—
Approve requisition	—	A	—	—	—
Choose which vendors receive it	Suggest	F	—	—	—
See internal budget ceiling on a requisition	F	F	R	—	—
Assign a hiring manager to a requisition	F	F	—	—	—
Receive released requirement	—	—	—	F	S (assigned)
Submit candidate profile	—	—	—	F	F
Screen / shortlist / reject candidate	R	R	F	—	—
Schedule and conduct interviews	Optional panel	—	F	—	—
Raise offer	R	R	F	—	—
Approve offer	A	A (rate compliance)	—	—	—
See vendor scorecards	R (own reqs)	F	R	R (own)	—
See other vendors' names or submissions	F	F	F	—	—

3. The contract requisition — data model

This is the heart of v2.0. A contract requisition is not a job posting with a duration bolted on. The commercial and compliance fields are as load-bearing as the JD.

3.1 Section A — Role definition

Field	Type	Required	Notes
Job title	Text	Yes	e.g. DevOps Engineer
Job family	Select	Yes	Drives which vendors are eligible (category scope)
Job description	Rich text or file upload	Yes	See 3.7 — both entry paths must work
Must-have skills	Multi-tag	Yes	Min 3. Used for vendor matching and later for ranking
Good-to-have skills	Multi-tag	No	
Minimum experience	Number (years)	Yes	
Maximum experience	Number (years)	Yes	Contract roles need a ceiling; over-qualified candidates decline or leave
Education requirement	Select	No	
Certifications required	Multi-tag	No	e.g. AWS SA, CKA — common gate for DevOps
Headcount	Number	Yes	Default 1

3.2 Section B — Engagement terms (*this is what makes it a contract requisition*)

Field	Type	Required	Notes
Engagement type	Select	Yes	Time & Material / Fixed-price / Contract-to-hire
Contract duration	Number + unit	Yes	e.g. 6 months
Target start date	Date	Yes	
Contract end date	Date (auto-computed)	Yes	Derived from start + duration; manually overridable
Extension likely	Yes / No / Maybe	Yes	Vendors price and pitch differently based on this. Materially affects candidate willingness.
Conversion to full-time possible	Yes / No	Yes	Only shown when engagement type is C2H
Conversion fee terms	Text	Conditional	Pulled from the vendor's Empanelment; read-only on the requisition
Notice period acceptable (max)	Select	Yes	Immediate / 15d / 30d / 45d / 60d. The single biggest source of wasted submissions.
Replacement guarantee period	Number (days)	Yes	Defaults from Empanelment terms

3.3 Section C — Commercials

Field	Type	Required	Visible to vendor	Notes
Rate basis	Select	Yes	Yes	Hourly / Daily / Monthly
Currency	Select	Yes	Yes	Default INR
Budgeted rate — maximum	Number	Yes	No, by default	The internal ceiling. Hidden by default.
Rate range shown to vendor	Number range	Yes	Yes	Typically set at 90–95% of the internal ceiling, leaving negotiation room
Rate card reference	Auto-linked	Yes	Yes	System pulls the agreed band for this role/experience/location from each vendor's Empanelment and validates against it
Total engagement value	Auto-computed	Yes	No	rate × expected hours × duration × headcount. Drives approval routing thresholds.
Cost centre	Select	Yes	No	
Project / PO code	Text	Conditional	No	Required if the client has PO-based procurement
Budget approved	Yes / No	Yes	No	If No, requisition cannot be released

3.4 Section D — Work arrangement

Field	Type	Required	Notes
Primary work location	Select	Yes	
Work mode	Select	Yes	Onsite / Hybrid / Remote
Onsite days per week	Number	Conditional	Required when Hybrid
Shift / working hours	Select + text	Yes	Critical for DevOps — on-call and night shift change the rate
On-call expected	Yes / No	Yes	
Timezone overlap required	Text	No	e.g. 4 hours with US Central
Travel required	Yes / No + %	No	

3.5 Section E — Compliance and access

Field	Type	Required	Notes
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Background verification level	Select	Yes	Basic / Standard / Enhanced. Determines onboarding lead time.
BGV paid by	Select	Yes	Client / Vendor
NDA required	Yes / No	Yes	
Client-site access needed	Yes / No	Yes	
Laptop / asset provided by	Select	Yes	Client / Vendor. A frequent post-offer dispute.
Statutory compliance notes	Text	No	PF/ESI applicability, GST treatment
Client policies to acknowledge	File attach	No	

3.6 Section F — Process and ownership

Field	Type	Required	Notes
Requisition owner	Auto (creator)	Yes	Rajesh
Hiring manager	User picker	Yes	Arun — the person who will screen and interview
Additional reviewers	User picker	No	
Interview rounds	Structured list	Yes	Round name, type, duration, panel
Submission deadline	Date	Yes	Hard stop for vendor submissions
First-submission SLA	Hours	Yes	Default 48h
Max submissions per vendor	Number	Yes	Default 5
Priority	Select	Yes	Critical / High / Normal

3.7 JD entry — two paths, both mandatory

Rajesh will do one of two things, and the product must handle both equally well.

Path 1 — Upload an existing JD. He already has a DOCX or PDF from a previous hire. He uploads it. The system parses it and prefills title, skills, experience range, and location into the structured fields. He corrects what's wrong. *The parsed output must be presented as editable prefilled fields, never as a silent import* — parsing errors that go unreviewed become vendor confusion.

Path 2 — Compose in the product. He starts from a template for his job family, or writes free-form with a rich text editor.

In both cases, structured fields are the source of truth for matching, validation, and reporting. The JD document is an attachment that vendors also see. If a JD document says "3+ years" and the structured field says 5–8, the structured field governs and the system flags the mismatch before release.

3.8 Requisition states



Expired fires automatically at the submission deadline with headcount unfilled, and notifies both the requisition owner and HR.

4. Vendor panel management — the HR Manager module

Kavita's primary workspace. This is the module that makes her the owner of vendor relationships rather than a forwarder of emails.

4.1 Requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority
VP-01	Add a vendor to the panel by inviting via email. Vendor self-registers and creates their own tenant.	P0
VP-02	Bulk-import an existing panel via CSV, with invitations dispatched in batch.	P0
VP-03	Panel list view showing, per vendor: name, tier, status, category scope, active requisitions, submissions this quarter, shortlist rate, compliance status, contract expiry.	P0
VP-04	Edit any Empanelment attribute: tier, category scope, permitted locations, rate card, commercial terms, SLA	P0

	targets, ownership window. All edits versioned and audit-logged.	
VP-05	Set category scope per vendor: which job families, business units, and locations this vendor may receive requirements for. This is what determines who receives Rajesh's DevOps requisition.	P0
VP-06	Compliance checklist per vendor with document upload, verification workflow, and expiry tracking. Configurable per client.	P0
VP-07	Suspend a vendor — immediately stops new requirement releases, preserves in-flight submissions, notifies the vendor with reason.	P0
VP-08	Remove / terminate a vendor — requires explicit confirmation, mandatory reason, and a decision on what happens to in-flight candidates (transfer, close, or allow to complete).	P0
VP-09	Rate card per vendor per job family: experience band → location → min/max bill rate, with effective dates and version history.	P0
VP-10	Vendor scorecard per Empanelment, with tier-change recommendations based on trailing performance.	P1
VP-11	Panel gap analysis: flag job families where fewer than N compliant vendors are scoped, so gaps surface before a requisition sits unfilled.	P2

4.2 The removal question

VP-08 is deceptively hard. When Kavita removes Zenith from the panel, Zenith may have 6 candidates in active pipelines, 1 at offer stage, and 2 contractors already placed and working. Removal cannot simply revoke access.

Specified behaviour: removal sets the Empanelment to **Terminated** with an effective date. New releases stop immediately. Kavita must resolve each in-flight item explicitly — close, transfer to another vendor, or allow to run to completion. Placed contractors continue under the original terms until their engagement ends. The vendor retains read-only access scoped strictly to those in-flight items until they close.

5. Distribution — who receives Rajesh's requisition

On HR approval, the system computes the eligible vendor set:

```
Eligible = Empanelments where
  status = Active
  AND compliance = Valid
  AND job_family ∈ vendor.category_scope
  AND requisition.location ∈ vendor.permitted_locations
  AND vendor has a rate card covering this role + experience band
```

Kavita then chooses one of three release strategies:

Strategy	Behaviour	When to use
All eligible	Release to every eligible vendor simultaneously	Hard-to-fill roles, urgent priority
Selected	Kavita picks specific vendors from the eligible list	Niche skills where only two vendors have a track record
Tiered waves	Tier 1 immediately; if fewer than N qualified submissions within H hours, auto-release to Tier 2, then Tier 3	The default. Rewards good vendors with first look, and protects against panel-wide spam.

Vendors never learn who else received the requirement. They see submission slots remaining against their own cap and nothing about panel composition.

5.1 What the vendor receives

Shown to vendor	Hidden from vendor
Job title, JD document, full role definition	Internal budgeted maximum
Duration, start date, extension likelihood	Cost centre, PO code, total engagement value
Rate range (the vendor-facing range, not the ceiling)	Requisition owner's name
Work location, mode, shift, on-call	Hiring manager's name and contact
Notice period ceiling, BGV level, asset provider	Which other vendors received it

Submission deadline, SLA countdown, their own submission cap	Other vendors' submission counts
Client name and their assigned HR contact	Internal notes, interview feedback

6. Vendor workspace

Not a portal. A working surface where a recruiter spends her day across multiple clients.

ID	Requirement	Priority
VW-01	Unified requirement inbox across all clients the vendor serves, with SLA countdown, submission slots remaining, and deadline.	P0
VW-02	Filter and sort by client, job family, SLA urgency, deadline, assigned recruiter.	P0
VW-03	Vendor Admin assigns a requirement to one or more of their recruiters; unassigned requirements sit in a shared queue.	P0
VW-04	Requirement detail view showing the full vendor-visible field set plus the downloadable JD.	P0
VW-05	Submit a candidate: resume upload with parsing, structured profile, availability, current and expected rate, notice period, screening notes, consent affirmation.	P0
VW-06	Rate validation at submission: if expected rate exceeds the vendor's rate-card ceiling for this role and band, block the submission and offer an override request routed to HR.	P0
VW-07	Notice-period validation: warn when the candidate's notice exceeds the requisition ceiling, since this is the highest-frequency wasted submission.	P0
VW-08	Duplicate check runs on submit, before the recruiter has invested effort in formatting.	P0
VW-09	Reusable candidate database scoped to the vendor tenant, so a candidate submitted to PepsiCo can be resubmitted elsewhere in two clicks.	P1
VW-10	Status board across all clients: every submitted candidate, current stage, days in stage, rejection reason when rejected.	P0
VW-11	Own scorecard, visible always — submission-to-shortlist rate, SLA adherence, offer-drop rate.	P1

The product's obligation to the vendor is honest, fast feedback. A rejection with a structured reason within 48 hours is worth more to Meera than any feature. It is also the thing that makes her sourcing better on the next requirement, which makes the client's outcome better. This is the flywheel.

7. Hiring manager pipeline

Arun's surface. He receives profiles, not requisitions.

ID	Requirement	Priority
HM-01	Landing view scoped to requisitions where he is the assigned hiring manager.	P0
HM-02	Profiles arriving from vendors land in a New queue with vendor attribution, rate, notice period, and availability visible without opening the record.	P0
HM-03	Inline shortlist and reject from the queue, without navigating to a detail page.	P0
HM-04	Resume viewer opens in a side panel over the queue, not as navigation.	P0
HM-05	Rejection requires a structured reason from a configurable taxonomy; the reason is shared with the vendor by default.	P0
HM-06	Rate shown as a compliance verdict (within band / above band), rather than exceeding the internal ceiling	P0

	above band) rather than exposing the internal ceiling.	
HM-07	Side-by-side comparison of up to 4 candidates on rate, experience, notice, and skills match.	P1
HM-08	Interview scheduling with slot proposal to the vendor, who confirms with the candidate.	P0
HM-09	Structured interview feedback with competency ratings and a recommendation.	P0
HM-10	Raise offer; routes to the requisition owner and HR for approval when outside band.	P0
HM-11	Ageing alerts on his own inaction, framed as consequence: candidates waiting, vendors deprioritising.	P1
HM-12	Full functionality on mobile web. Arun reviews profiles between meetings.	P0

8. Notification matrix

Event	Requisition Owner	HR Manager	Hiring Manager	Vendor
Requisition submitted for approval	Confirmation	Action required	—	—
Requisition approved and released	Notify	Confirmation	Notify	New requirement
Requisition on hold or cancelled	Notify	Notify	Notify	Notify with reason
Candidate submitted	—	—	Action required	Confirmation
Duplicate blocked at submission	—	Notify	—	Notify (no vendor name revealed)
Candidate shortlisted	—	—	Confirmation	Notify
Candidate rejected	—	—	Confirmation	Notify with reason
Interview scheduled	—	—	Calendar invite	Notify, confirm slot
First-submission SLA breached	Notify	Escalation	Notify	Reminder
Submission deadline in 24h	Notify	Notify	—	Reminder
Offer raised	Action required	Action if out of band	Confirmation	—
Offer released	Notify	Notify	Notify	Action required
Candidate joined	Notify	Notify	Notify	Confirmation
Vendor document expiring	—	Action required	—	Action required
Vendor suspended or removed	—	Confirmation	Notify if affected	Notify with reason

9. Screen inventory for v2.0

#	Screen	Persona	Purpose
S1	My requirements	Requisition Owner	Status of everything he has raised
S2	Create requisition	Requisition Owner	Sectioned form with JD upload or compose
S3	Approval queue	HR Manager	Fast approve/release decision with rate validation on one screen
S4	Vendor panel	HR Manager	Add, edit, tier, suspend, remove empanelled vendors
S5	Vendor detail	HR Manager	Compliance, rate card, scorecard, category scope
S6	Requirement inbox	Vendor Recruiter	All open requirements across clients with SLA and slots
S7	Requirement detail + submit	Vendor Recruiter	Vendor-visible JD and the submission form

S8	Submission tracker	Vendor Recruiter	Status of every candidate across clients
S9	Candidate queue	Hiring Manager	Profiles awaiting screening with inline decisions
S10	Candidate detail panel	Hiring Manager	Resume viewer, vendor notes, decision controls
S11	Interview scheduling	Hiring Manager	Slot proposal and feedback capture
S12	Offer	Hiring Manager + Owner	Raise, validate, approve, release

10. Open questions

#	Question	Why it matters
Q1	Is the Engineering Director always distinct from the Hiring Manager, or do they collapse in most orgs? If they collapse, S1/S2 and S9 belong to one persona and the approval chain shortens.	Changes the entire role model
Q2	Can a Hiring Manager raise a requisition, or only a Requisition Owner above a certain grade?	Approval routing
Q3	Should the vendor see the client's rate range at all, or submit blind and let the client filter? Showing it anchors expectations upward; hiding it wastes submissions.	Section 5.1
Q4	Does HR approve every requisition, or only those outside the rate card or above a value threshold? Auto-approving within-band requisitions removes Kavita as a bottleneck for routine roles.	Approval workflow, adoption
Q5	Who talks to the candidate about scheduling — the vendor, or the client directly? Vendor-mediated protects vendor relationships but adds latency.	HM-08
Q6	For a 6-month engagement, does the system track and prompt for extension decisions at month 5? This is where a lot of contract-hiring pain actually lives.	Post-placement scope, likely Phase 2

Appendix — contract vs permanent field differences

For reference when explaining the product's positioning:

Concept	Permanent hiring	Termjobs (contract)
Compensation	Annual CTC, fixed + variable + equity	Bill rate per hour/day/month
Duration	Indefinite	Fixed, with an explicit end date
Sourcing	Job boards, referrals, direct	Empanelled vendor panel only
Cost centre	Headcount budget	Project budget or PO
Employer	Client	Vendor
Exit	Resignation	Contract end, or early termination clause
Key risk	Attrition	Non-renewal, replacement lead time, rate creep
Repeat demand	Rare for the same role	Very common — same role, new project, every quarter